



This Year's Town Report is dedicated to Marguerite Willis.

Marguerite has been a resident of Charlemont for 34 years moving here with her late husband Alan Willis. She spent many years volunteering in the community, including participating in the Charlemont Women's Club, reading at Hawlemont, and working on the flower garden near the school entrance. Marguerite was also responsible (with others) for the revival of Yankee Doodle Days in the early 2000's.

Marguerite has served as a selectboard member, a school committee member, planning board member, and an EMT on the Charlemont Ambulance. She is currently a town registrar of voters. She is an enthusiastic participant in town politics and often participates in town meetings offering support to issues she is passionate about.

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United States Senators

Elizabeth Warren

Ed Markey

Massachusetts Governor

Maura Healey

U.S. Representative, District 1

Richard Neal

State Senator

Paul W. Mark

House of Representatives, 1st Franklin District

Natalie Blais

Franklin Regional Council of Governments Executive Committee

Linda Dunlavy – Executive Director

Jay DiPucchio, Chair

Jane Peirce, Vice Chair

Rebekah Boyd – Administrative Services Coordinator

Bee Jacque, Secretary/Clerk

Virginia Desorgher

Emily Johnson

Town Officers

Select Board

Valentine Reid, Chair - Term Expires 2025

Jared Bellows - Term Expires 2027

Kim Blakeslee - Term Expires 2026

Moderator

Robert Handsaker

Town Administrator

Sarah Reynolds

Town Clerk

Thorne Palmer

Town Treasurer and Tax Collector

Lynn Hathaway

Assessor and Finance Committee Clerk

Carlene Hayden

Secretary to the Boards

Star Atkeson

Emergency Management Director

Dennis Annear

Fire Department

Dennis Annear, Chief

Ambulance Director

Dana Johnson

Police Department

Jason Pelletier, Chief

Highway Superintendent

Scott Sullivan

Animal Inspector

Robert Lingle

Animal Control Officer

Kyle Dragon

Tree Warden

Andy Mueller

Term Expires 2025

Constables

Jared Bellows – Term Expires 2027
Erwin Reynolds – Term Expires 2025
William Harker – Term Expires 2026

Flag Committee

Jerry Dupree

Fence Viewer, Field Driver, Pound Keeper

Vacant

Measurer of Wood and Bark and Lumber

Vacant

Franklin County Cooperative Inspection Program

Jim Hawkins, Building Inspector
Jeff Gougeon, Building Inspector

Franklin County Plumbing and Wiring Inspection Program

Dana Spring, Wiring Inspector
Andrew French, Plumbing Inspector

Franklin Regional Transit Authority Representative

Valentine Reid Sarah Reynolds, Alternate

Franklin County Solid Waste Management District Representative

Valentine Reid Sarah Reynolds, Alternate

Planning Board

Robert Nelson, Chair – Term Expires 2026
Jennifer Mooney – Term Expires 2026
Lori Shulda-Merrigan – Term Expires 2025
Liz Bouyea – Term Expires 2027
Vacant – Term Expires 2029
Associate Member, Bill Harker – Term Expires 2027

Zoning Board of Appeals

Ronald Smith – Term Expires 2026
Charlotte Dewey – Term Expires 2025
Frank Carcio – Term Expires 2027
Vacant, Associate Member

Finance Committee

Richard Filoramo, Chair – Term Expires 2027
Amy Wales – Term Expires 2027
Lynn Hathaway – Term Expires 2025
Jay Healy – Term Expires 2026
Ron Smith – Term Expires 2026

Capital Planning Committee

Mike Hayden – Term Expires 2027
Tony Walker – Term Expires 2025
Ronald Smith – Term Expires 2026

Board of Health

Douglas Telling, Co-Chair – Term Expires 2027
Robert Lingle, Co-Chair – Term Expires 2026
Mae Tanner – Term Expires 2025

Board of Assessors

Karen Rau, Chair - Term Expires 2026
Jacqueline Cashin - Term Expires 2025
Anthony Ostroski - Term Expires 2027

Agricultural/ Forest Commission

Randy Prostack, Chair – Term Expires 2026
Sonny Crawford – Term Expires 2025
Victoria Valenti – Term Expires 2026
Nathaniel Bellows – Term Expires 2026
Vacant – Term Expires 2027

Alternates

Clare Pearson – Term Expires 2027
Paul Hicks – Term Expires 2027

Board of Registrars

Cheryl Handsaker – Term Expires 2027
Patricia Bergeron – Term Expires 2026
Marguerite Willis – Term Expires 2025
Thorne Palmer – Town Clerk

Charlemont School Committee

Elizabeth Van Iderstine - Term Expires 2026
Anne Kaplan - Term Expires 2025
Betty Barrett – Term Expires 2027

Hawlemont School Committee

Elizabeth Van Iderstine, Chair (Charlemont)

Anne Kaplan (Charlemont)

Betty Barrett (Charlemont)

Kenneth Bertsch (Hawley)

Elizabeth Billings (Hawley)

Peggy Travers (Hawley)

Mohawk Trail Regional School Committee

Evie Locke - Term Expires 2025

Vacant - Term Expires 2027

Local Education Council

Ashley Sparks – Term Expires 2026

Library Trustees

Evelyn Locke, Chair – Term Expires 2025

Andrea Santos – Term Expires 2026

Esther Haskell – Term Expires 2027

Council on Aging

Linda Wagner, Chair/ Treasurer

Marjorie Porrovecchio, Secretary

Betty Hicks Agnes Newland

Nancy Noonan

Linda Reynolds

Artis Noland

Trustees of the East Charlemont School

(The Little Red Schoolhouse)

Lida Bihun-Forbes, Chair - Term Expires 2026

Emily Crawford, Secretary - Term Expires 2028

Bambi Miller - Term Expires 2025

Elizabeth Healy - Term Expires 2025

William Harker - Term Expires 2028

Kerlin Coyningham - Term Expires 2027

Kate Stevens – Term Expires 2026

Historical Commission

William Coli – Term Expires 2026

Norma Coli – Term Expires 2027

Bambi Miller – Term Expires 2025

Parks and Recreation Commission

Michael Hayden, Chair – Term Expires 2026

William Harker – Term Expires 2028

Neil Neuhauser – Term Expires 2027

Jacqueline Cashin – Term expires 2025

Thomas Shields – Term Expires 2029

Charlemont Historical Society

Joanne MacLean

Conservation Commission

Thorne Palmer, Chair – Term Expires 2025

Bill Harker – Term Expires 2027

Clay Herbert – Term Expires 2026

Scott Randall – Term Expires 2026

Andrea Santos - Term Expires 2027

Earth Removal Committee

William Harker – Term Expires 2026

Robert Lingle – Term Expires 2026

Erwin Reynolds – Term Expires 2025

Gisela Walker – Term Expires 2027

Vacant – Term Expires 2027

Charlemont-Hawley Cultural Council

From Charlemont

Colleen Champ – Term Expires 2027

Andrea Santos – Treasurer, Term Expires 2025 (2nd term)

Anna Otto, Secretary – Term Expires 2026 (2nd term)

Zorah Miller – Term Expires 2026 (1st term)

From Hawley

Tinky Weisblat, Chair – Term Expires 2024

Peter Beck – Term Expires 2026

Ryan Brownell – Term Expires 2024

Joanne MacLean – Term Expires 2025

Town Calendar – Fiscal Year 2026

Tuesday, May 27, 2025	Annual Town Meeting
Tuesday, June 3, 2025	Town Election
Thursday, June 19, 2025	Juneteenth
Friday, July 4, 2025	Independence Day
Monday, September 1, 2025	Labor Day
Monday, October 13, 2025	Indigenous People's / Columbus Day
Tuesday, November 11, 2025	Veterans Day
Thursday, November 27, 2025	Thanksgiving
Thursday, December 25, 2025	Christmas
Thursday, January 1, 2026	New Years Day
Monday, January 19, 2026	Martin Luther King Day
Monday, February 16, 2026	Presidents' Day
Friday, May 15, 2026	Peace Officers Memorial Day
Monday, May 25, 2026	Memorial Day
Tuesday, May 26, 2026	Annual Town Meeting

Charlemont Local Election Results for June 4, 2024

Select Board (3 Years)		Planning Board (2 Years)	
Jared C Bellows	170	Elizabeth Bouyea	12
Blank	17	Kim Blakeslee	3
Charlie Ricko	1	Jeff Brisson	3
Kim Blakeslee	1	Bill Harker	2
		Doug Annear	1
Select Board (2 Years)		Wilder Sparks	1
Kim Blakeslee	95	John Hoffman	1
Stephen W Thayer	77	Gisela Walker	1
Blank	16	Blank	165
Robert Handsaker	1		
Town Moderator (1 Year)		Planning Board Associate (3 Year)	
Robert E Handsaker	165	Bill Harker	12
Blank	24	Tina Fitzroy	1
		Norma Coli	1
Board of Assessors (3 Years)		Ken Hall	1
Anthony J Ostroski	167	Elizabeth Bouyea	1
Blank	22	Dan Miller	1
		Blank	172
Board of Health (3 Years)		Charlemont School Committee (3 Years)	
Doug Telling	9	John S Hoffman	161
Jonathan Mirin	3	Blank	28
Lydia Brisson	3		
Amy Coates	1	Mohawk Trail School Committee (3 Years)	
Bill Coli	1	Kate Stevens	2
Camile White	1	Evie Locke	2
Joe Purinton	1	Julia White	1
Blank	170	Ellie VanInderstine	1
		Blank	183
Planning Board (5 Years)		Local Education Council (2 Years)	
Elizabeth Bouyea	5	Ashley Sparks	153
Bill Harker	2	Blank	36
Bill Coli	1		
John Hoffman	1	Tyler Memorial Library Trustee (3 Years)	
Doug White	1	Esther A Haskell	167
Sarah Slowinski	1	Blank	22
Karen Hogness	1		
Cheryl Handsaker	1	Parks and Rec Commissioner (5 Years)	
Blank	176	Thomas W Shields	165
Constable (3 Years)		Jerry Dupree	3
Jared C Bellows	175	Elizabeth Bouyea	1
Blank	14	Jeff Brisson	1
		Steve Thayer	1
		Blank	29



Minutes for the 2024 ANNUAL TOWN MEETING TOWN OF CHARLEMONT COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS

Tuesday, the Twenty-eighth day of May, AD 2024 at 6:00 p.m.

in the **Hawlemont School gym** at 10 School Street in said Charlemont

The Town Clerk opened the meeting at 6:03

The Town Clerk reported that we had reached a quorum.

The Town Clerk reported that the warrant for the May 28th, 2024 annual town meeting had been duly posted as required by law.

The Town Clerk called for the election of a temporary Moderator to facilitate the 2024 Town Meeting. Moved and seconded. Called for volunteers – Ron Smith alone stepped forward.

Ron Smith was elected unanimously.

Ron Smith proceeded to facilitate action on the following articles:

Article 1: To act on the Report of the Town Officers.

Article requires a majority vote. Passed Unanimously.

Article 2: To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Select Board to apply for and accept any and all Federal and State grants or gifts from individuals or non-profit organizations which may become available during the fiscal year 2025.

Article requires a majority vote. Passed Unanimously.

Article 3: To see if the Town will authorize the Treasurer to enter into a compensating balance agreement or agreements for fiscal year 2025, pursuant to Chapter 44, Section 53F of the Massachusetts General Laws.

Article requires a majority vote. Passed Unanimously.

Article 4: To see if the Town will vote to establish the spending limits for the following revolving funds for fiscal year 2025: